

Claude Cowork

Masterclass Level 2

Browser Agent | Excel & PowerPoint | Advanced Prompting

01 - Recap & Setup
02 - Claude in Chrome
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Recap & Advanced Setup

What We Covered in Masterclass 1

In the first session we walked through Claude Cowork basics — installing the desktop app, connecting your Anthropic account, running simple file tasks, and using Claude Cowork as a day-to-day productivity layer on your Mac or Windows machine.

Masterclass 1 Topic	Status
Install Claude Cowork desktop app	✓ Done
Connect Anthropic API / Claude.ai account	✓ Done
Basic file summarisation & Q&A;	✓ Done
Simple automation tasks (rename, organise)	✓ Done
Intro to Claude in Chrome beta	✓ Done

Advanced Setup Checklist

- Claude Cowork desktop app — latest version installed (check for updates)
- Claude Pro or Team plan active (required for Claude in Chrome / Excel / PPT)
- Google Chrome — version 120+ for the Chrome extension
- Microsoft Excel — Microsoft 365 subscription for the Excel add-in
- Microsoft PowerPoint — same 365 subscription
- Stable internet — all beta tools require cloud inference

■ PRO TIP	Claude Cowork itself is free to download but the AI features require an active Claude.ai Pro or Team subscription. If you are on Free tier, upgrade before this session.
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Claude in Chrome — Browser Agent

What is Claude in Chrome?

Claude in Chrome is a beta browser agent that lets Claude see your active browser tab and take actions — clicking, filling forms, scrolling, extracting data — without you writing a single line of code. Think of it as a smart intern who can browse the web on your behalf while you supervise.

How to Install & Enable

- Open Claude Cowork → Settings → Integrations → Enable 'Claude in Chrome'
- Install the Chrome extension from the link shown in Cowork settings
- Pin the extension to your toolbar and click Connect
- Grant tab-read and interaction permissions when prompted
- A green dot in Cowork confirms the browser is connected

Core Capabilities

Capability	Example Prompt
Read page content	"Summarise this article and give me 3 key points"
Form filling	"Fill the contact form with my details from my notes"
Data extraction	"Extract all product names and prices from this page into a table"
Multi-tab research	"Open the top 3 results for 'n8n pricing' and compare them"
Scroll & paginate	"Scroll to the bottom and extract all comments"
Click & navigate	"Click the Download button and tell me what file was saved"

Advanced Prompting for Chrome Agent

The Chrome agent is most powerful when you give it structured, goal-oriented instructions rather than vague requests. Follow the pattern below:

GOAL → CONTEXT → CONSTRAINTS → OUTPUT FORMAT

Example — Competitive Research Prompt:

"Go to g2.com and search for 'n8n'. Open the first 5 reviews. For each review extract: reviewer role, rating out of 5, top positive point, top negative point. Return a markdown table. Do not navigate away from G2."

■■ IMPORTANT

Claude in Chrome cannot bypass paywalls, CAPTCHAs, or login walls it hasn't been given credentials for. Never give Claude your passwords directly — use the browser's saved credentials instead and let Claude trigger the saved fill.

Real Project: Tamil YouTube Research Bot

Here is a workflow you can build live during the masterclass session:

- Open YouTube and search for top 10 Tamil AI channels
- For each channel: extract subscriber count, last upload date, and top video title
- Paste result into Excel (Claude in Excel will clean & format it automatically)
- Ask Claude to identify content gaps — topics they haven't covered yet

■ PRO TIP

This 4-step research workflow replaces 2-3 hours of manual work. Demonstrate this live to show students the real power of chaining tools.

SECTION 03

Claude in Excel — Spreadsheet Agent

Installing the Excel Add-in

- Open Microsoft Excel → Insert → Get Add-ins → Search 'Claude'
- Click Add next to the official Anthropic add-in
- A Claude panel appears on the right side of Excel
- Sign in with your Claude.ai account inside the panel
- Select any cell range → right-click → 'Ask Claude about selection'

What Claude in Excel Can Do

Task Type	What Claude Does	Time Saved
Formula Generation	Write complex nested IF, VLOOKUP, XLOOKUP formulas from plain English	30 min → 30 sec
Data Cleaning	Fix inconsistent date formats, remove duplicates, normalise text	1 hr → 2 min
Data Analysis	Summarise a 5000-row sheet — trends, outliers, top/bottom performers	2 hr → 5 min
Chart Recommendation	Suggest the best chart type for your data and explain why	15 min → 1 min
Pivot Table Help	Guide you step-by-step to build the right pivot for your question	20 min → 3 min
Report Narrative	Write a plain-English summary of a data table for a non-tech audience	45 min → 5 min

Advanced Excel Prompts (Tanglish Style)

"A1:F200 range la sales data iruku. Month-wise total revenue calculate pannu, "

"top 5 products identify pannu, and highlight negative growth months in red."

"This column has dates in 3 different formats – DD/MM/YYYY, MM-DD-YY, and plain text. Normalise all of them to YYYY-MM-DD format and put results in column G."

■ PRO TIP

Always select the exact range before sending a prompt. Claude in Excel uses your selection as context — without a selection it guesses, which may be wrong.

Live Demo Project: 3D Toy Business Tracker

Build a business tracker for a ₹1 Crore revenue goal business (great for Tamil audience who relate to real Indian business context):

- Column A: Product name (Toy car, Figurine, Custom order...)
- Column B: Units produced per month
- Column C: Selling price (₹)
- Column D: Material cost per unit (₹)
- Prompt Claude: 'Calculate gross profit, net margin, and monthly run-rate toward ₹1Cr annual target'
- Prompt Claude: 'Which product has the best margin? How many units/month needed to hit ₹1Cr?'

SECTION 04

Claude in PowerPoint — Slides Agent

Installing & Connecting

- PowerPoint → Insert → Get Add-ins → Search 'Claude' → Add
- Same Claude.ai sign-in as Excel add-in
- Claude panel appears on the right — select any slide to give context
- Or open a blank presentation and describe what you want built

Key Use Cases

Use Case	Prompt Pattern
Generate full deck	"Create a 10-slide pitch deck for a Tamil AI education startup targeting college students"
Improve existing slide	"This slide is too text-heavy. Rewrite it as 3 bullet points with a strong headline"
Speaker notes	"Write detailed speaker notes for slide 4 in a conversational Tamil-English style"
Story structure	"Reorder these slides to follow a Problem → Solution → Proof → CTA structure"
Repurpose content	"I have a blog post (pasted below). Convert it into a 6-slide summary deck"

Advanced Technique: Deck from YouTube Script

This is a killer workflow for content creators and educators:

- Write your YouTube video script in a text file
- Open PowerPoint + Claude panel

- Paste script → Prompt: 'Convert this script into a slide deck. Each major topic = 1 slide. Use short headlines, 3 bullets max per slide. Add a title slide and a CTA slide at the end.'
- Claude generates the full structure — you just adjust design
- Export as PDF for your channel community downloads

■ PRO TIP	Claude in PowerPoint works on content and structure, not design themes. Use PowerPoint Designer (built-in) after Claude fills the content for instant visual polish.
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SECTION 05

Advanced Prompt Engineering for Cowork

The CRISP Framework

Use this framework for any Claude Cowork prompt — browser, Excel, or PowerPoint:

Letter	Stands For	Example
C	Context	"I run a 3D printing business with 4 machines..."
R	Role	"Act as a financial analyst..."
I	Instructions	"Calculate monthly profit and highlight top product..."
S	Scope/Constraints	"Only use columns A to F, don't touch the formula sheet..."
P	Output format	"Return a table with 4 columns, sorted by margin descending"

Chaining Prompts (Multi-turn Strategy)

Don't try to do everything in one prompt. Break complex tasks into a chain:

- Step 1 — Setup prompt: Set role and context once at the start of the session
- Step 2 — Task prompt: Give the specific task with scope
- Step 3 — Refine prompt: Ask Claude to improve its own output ('Make it more concise')
- Step 4 — Format prompt: Ask for a specific output structure ('Now put this in a 3-column table')

Negative Constraints (What NOT to Do)

Always tell Claude what to avoid — this dramatically reduces hallucinations and off-scope actions:

"Do NOT modify rows below row 200. Do NOT add new columns. Do NOT use macros. Only use standard Excel formulas."

■ PRO TIP	Negative constraints are the #1 underused technique. Advanced users always include them. Teach your audience this habit from day one.
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Workflow Design — Connecting the Tools

The Cowork Power Stack

The real magic happens when you chain Claude Cowork's tools together into a single end-to-end workflow. Here are three powerful stacks:

Stack 1 — Research → Report

Chrome Agent (collect data) → Excel Agent (organise & analyse) → PowerPoint Agent (present)

Stack 2 — Content Machine

Chrome Agent (YouTube trend research) → Claude Cowork (write script) → PowerPoint Agent (slides for community)

Stack 3 — Business Dashboard

Excel Agent (clean raw sales data) → Excel Agent (build pivot analysis) → PowerPoint Agent (monthly review deck)

Human-in-the-Loop Design

Claude Cowork tools are agentic but not fully autonomous — they require your approval for actions that modify files or interact with the web. Design your workflows with checkpoints:

- After Chrome extraction — review the data before passing to Excel
- After Excel analysis — verify formulas are correct before using in decisions
- After PowerPoint generation — proofread slides before sharing externally
- Never let the agent overwrite your original data — always work on a copy

■ ■ ■ IMPORTANT	Claude Cowork agents can take real actions — submitting forms, editing live files. Always test on sample/dummy data first. Treat it like a junior employee: supervise until you trust the output.
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Real Projects — Hands-On Session

Project 1: AI Community Content Calendar

Goal: Build a 30-day content calendar for an AI Tamil YouTube channel.

- Chrome Agent → Search 'trending AI topics India 2025' and extract top 20 topics

- Excel Agent → Organise topics by category (Tools / Tutorials / News / Case Studies)
- Excel Agent → Add columns for platform (YouTube/Instagram/LinkedIn), format, and hook idea
- Claude Cowork → Generate 30 post ideas mapped to the calendar
- PowerPoint Agent → Create a visual calendar slide for team review

Project 2: Startup Pitch Deck Builder

Goal: Go from idea to investor-ready deck in under 30 minutes.

- Write a 5-sentence description of your startup idea in a text file
- Claude Cowork → Expand into a one-pager (problem, solution, market, team, ask)
- PowerPoint Agent → 'Build a 12-slide investor pitch deck from this one-pager'
- Slides: Title, Problem, Solution, Market Size, Product Demo, Business Model, Traction, Team, Financials, Roadmap, Ask, Contact
- Add speaker notes in Tamil for each slide using Claude in PPT

Project 3: Automated Competitor Price Tracker

Goal: Track competitor pricing weekly without coding.

- Chrome Agent → Visit 5 competitor websites and extract pricing page data
- Excel Agent → Build a comparison matrix (tier names, price, features included)
- Excel Agent → Highlight where your product is cheaper/more expensive
- Excel Agent → 'Write a 3-sentence positioning recommendation based on this data'

■ PRO TIP

For weekly tracking, save the Chrome prompt and Excel template. Each week just re-run the same prompt — 10 minutes vs 2 hours of manual work.

SECTION 08

Limits, Errors & Troubleshooting

Known Limitations

Limitation	Workaround
Chrome agent can't handle CAPTCHA	Solve CAPTCHA manually, then hand back to agent
Excel add-in slow on large sheets (>10K rows)	Sample 500 rows first, validate, then run on full data
PPT agent doesn't apply design themes	Use PowerPoint Designer after Claude fills content
Context window — very long pages/sheets may truncate	Break task into sections; process page by page
Beta tools may be unavailable during outages	Check status.anthropic.com ; keep Claude.ai web as fallback

Chrome extension may need tab refresh to reconnect	Close and reopen the tab; click Reconnect in Cowork
File permission errors on Mac	System Preferences → Privacy → Files & Folders → Allow Cowork

Common Error Messages & Fixes

- "Rate limit exceeded"
- Wait 60 seconds. You've hit Claude Pro's per-minute token limit. Break large tasks into smaller prompts.
- "I cannot see the page content"
- The Chrome extension lost its tab connection. Refresh the page, click Reconnect in Cowork, then retry.
- "Unable to edit this Excel file"
- The file may be read-only or shared in protected mode. Save a local copy and open that.

What's Coming Next (Roadmap Hints)

- Claude in Google Docs — likely next beta integration after Excel/PPT
- Multi-step automation recording — record a workflow once, replay on command
- Deeper Cowork ↔ n8n integration — trigger Cowork tasks from n8n workflows
- Mobile Cowork — early signals of iOS/Android companion app
- Local file access improvements — better handling of large PDFs and datasets

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